

■ INSIGHT COMPANION — INCLUDED WITH YOUR REPORT

The Function Stack in Depth

A field guide to Jung's eight cognitive functions: how each one perceives or judges, how they arrange into a stack, what happens at the dominant-inferior edge under stress, and how the pattern matures over a life.

Ti

Te

Fi

Fe

Si

Se

Ni

Ne

The label is the doorway, not the room.

Your TypeJung result is a hypothesis about energy: which of the eight cognitive functions your attention reaches for first, which ones support it, and which one sits least developed at the bottom of the stack. This guide is the theory behind that map. It follows Jung's Psychological Types, in plain language, and it is meant to be read next to your own result.

I The two attitudes — introversion and extraversion

II The eight functions, one by one

III The eight type patterns in life

IV The stack — dominant, auxiliary, tertiary, inferior

V The grip — what stress does to each pattern

VI Individuation — how the pattern matures

VII Practice — working with your own map

PART I — THE TWO ATTITUDES

Extraversion. In the extraverted attitude, libido flows outward from the subject to the object. The object (external reality, people, norms, things) acts as a magnet, drawing interest outward. The extravert expends energy, is prolific, propagating their nature into the world, forming attachments easily, and venturing with confidence into the unknown.

Introversion. In the introverted attitude, libido flows inward, withdrawing from the object back to the subject. The introvert interposes a subjective view between themselves and the world. The object is viewed with caution; the goal is to prevent the object from gaining power over the subject. They conserve energy and secure the 'inner fortress.'

Every function below exists in both attitudes. That is what turns four functions into eight, and what makes two people with “the same” thinking look nothing alike.

Ti Introverted Thinking

Oriented by the subjective factor, seeking the depth of the idea rather than the breadth of facts. They collect facts only as evidence for their internal premises. Kant is the prototype, contrasting with the 'Darwinian' extraverted thinker.

“Formulates questions and creates theories; opens up prospects and yields insight, but with respect to facts its attitude is one of reserve.”

— C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Precise, analytical, independent thinker. Master of troubleshooting and deep theoretical understanding. They seek intellectual intensity and trust the power of the idea itself, not pressing their views on others.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Reserved, often impractical, indifferent to the object. Their repressed feeling is objective, primitive, and anxious—they may have a naïve sensitivity to public opinion or be easily manipulated by emotional appeals they do not understand.

Te Extraverted Thinking

Organizes the external world through logical systems, objective criteria, and empirical facts. The extraverted thinker elevates objective reality and the 'intellectual formula' to the ruling principle of existence. Their life is governed by a dominating positive formula derived from objective facts or collective ideals.

“The man who refuses to obey the formula is wrong... he is unreasonable, immoral.”

— C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Efficient, clear-headed, just, productive. Excellent at organizing resources, leading execution, and bringing environments into alignment with logical principles. The reformers, prosecutors, and organizers of society.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Dogmatic, tyrannical, dismissive of personal values. Because feeling is repressed, it becomes archaic and highly personal—manifesting as hidden sentimentality, explosive anger, or sudden mystical attachments that contradict their logical exterior.

Fi Introverted Feeling

Governed by subjective feeling tones. Their motto is 'Still waters run deep.' They do not seek to influence the object but to secure the inner harmony of the subject. Their values are often archetypal (God, Freedom) but rarely articulated.

“It is determined by the subjective factor... they neither shine nor reveal themselves.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Authentic, principled, deeply compassionate. Silent inner intensity. Loyal to inner truth regardless of pressure, capable of profound empathy that is expressed through action rather than words.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Silent, inaccessible, often appearing cold or melancholic because feeling does not flow outward. Their repressed thinking is concrete, factual, and tyrannical—manifesting as ruthless drives to execute facts or monomania over single objective details.

Fe Extraverted Feeling

Oriented by objective emotional values and traditional standards. Their feeling aligns with the object: 'I love you because you are lovable' (objective reason), not merely 'because I like you.' They call a thing beautiful because it is collectively valued as such.

“Feeling is determined chiefly by the objective factor... it adapts itself entirely to the objective situation.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Harmonious, empathetic, socially graceful. They are the social glue—accommodating, warm, and vital for community. Excellent at building consensus, smoothing over conflicts, and maintaining rapport.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Their thinking is repressed, infantile, and often negative. When feeling adaptation fails, inferior thinking emerges as cynical 'nothing but' judgments, reducing the object to its basest components. Prone to paranoia and projection.

Si Introverted Sensation

Guided by the subjective intensity of the sense impression. Not the object itself, but the impression the object makes on the subject. A 'rainy day' is not just weather; it is a subjective atmosphere loaded with personal meaning—a mirror world of impressions.

“It is an unrelatedness to the object... the subject's perception of the object is the decisive factor.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Reliable, thorough, detail-oriented, grounded. May appear passive but internally processes a rich world. Often has an artistic or impressionistic relation to reality. Excellent at preserving traditions and learning from the past.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Repressed intuition is projected outward as fear of the unknown. They perceive the world as chaotic and threatening, seeing 'danger' in every new possibility. They cling to the familiar to ward off 'demonic' novelty.

Se Extraverted Sensation

The type of the 'extreme realist.' No other type equals their capacity for perceiving the concrete world. They are oriented toward the strongest objective stimulus—sensation is the 'fullness of life.' They accumulate actual experiences.

“No other human type can equal the extraverted sensation type in realism.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Realistic, observant, adaptable, aesthetically attuned. The aesthetes, the lovers of good food, fashion, and physical experiences. Fully present in the moment, pragmatic and grounded in reality.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Repressed intuition takes on a 'dark' and archaic quality. They project evil possibilities onto the environment, developing phobias, jealous fantasies, or superstitious fears about the future or others' intentions.

Ni Introverted Intuition

Directs intuition toward the inner objects (archetypes). The 'mystical dreamers' who perceive the background processes of consciousness—the 'slow processes' of the collective unconscious. Often have difficulty communicating their vision.

“It directs itself to the inner object... the contents of the unconscious.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Visionary, insightful, synthesizing, determined. 'The voice of one crying in the wilderness.' Artists, prophets, capable of profound foresight and realizing complex goals through singular vision.

THE SHADOW SIDE

Their link to reality is weak. Inferior sensation manifests as impulsive, raw sensuality or compulsive ties to specific persons or objects (fetishism). May be completely helpless in the physical world.

Ne Extraverted Intuition

Seeks possibilities in the objective world. They are the 'initiators' with a 'keen nose' for what is in the making. They seize a situation with enthusiasm but abandon it as soon as the potential is exhausted—'the harvest is nothing!'

“The intuitive is never to be found among the generally recognized reality values, but always where possibilities exist.”

– C. G. JUNG, PSYCHOLOGICAL TYPES

AT ITS BEST

Innovative, inspiring, adaptable, quick-witted. Entrepreneurs, speculators, and inspirers who see potential where others see dead ends. Energized by the new, the future, and 'what could be.'

THE SHADOW SIDE

Their sensation is suppressed, leading to neglect of the body and physical reality. This results in physical exhaustion, hypochondria, or sudden compulsive indulgences in sensory pleasure as the starved body demands attention.

Part III — How each dominant looks in a life.

Jung described eight characteristic types, one for each dominant function. Read yours, then read the one across the axis from it — that is the pattern your stress borrows from.

Ti The Introverted Thinking Type

ORIENTATION	Inner Idea—seeks the depth of the idea rather than the breadth of facts. Creates theories and systems.
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	Reserved, often impractical, the 'absent-minded professor.' Does not press views on others, trusting the power of the idea itself.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Isolation, participation mystique. Hidden naive sensitivity to public opinion. Can be manipulated by emotional appeals they don't understand.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Kant (contrasting with Darwin), theoretical physicists, philosophers of pure reason.

Te The Extraverted Thinking Type

ORIENTATION	Universal Formula—their life is governed by a 'dominating positive formula' derived from objective facts or collective ideals (Justice, Efficiency, Progress).
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	The reformers, prosecutors, and organizers. They strive to bring the environment into alignment with the formula. Confident, decisive, results-oriented.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Dogmatism, emotional outbursts. The 'tyranny' of the formula suppresses personal emotional life, causing the unconscious feeling to exact revenge through neurosis.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Darwin (collecting facts for objective theory), industrial organizers, efficiency consultants.

Fi The Introverted Feeling Type

ORIENTATION	Inner Value—'Still waters run deep.' Values often archetypal (God, Freedom) but rarely articulated.
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	Silent, inaccessible, often melancholic. May appear cold because feeling doesn't flow outward. 'They neither shine nor reveal themselves.'
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Melancholy, tyrannical logic. Repressed Te manifests as ruthless drives to execute facts or monomania.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Mystics, contemplatives, those with 'silent inner fires.'

Fe The Extraverted Feeling Type

ORIENTATION	Social Harmony—feeling aligns with objective values. 'Beautiful' because collectively valued, not because personally preferred.
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	The social glue—accommodating, warm, vital for community. Smooths over conflicts to maintain rapport. Fashion-conscious, tradition-respecting.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	'Hollow' personality, paranoia. When adaptation fails, inferior thinking emerges as cynical 'nothing but' judgments.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Social leaders, diplomats, those who embody collective emotional values.

Si

The Introverted Sensation Type

ORIENTATION	Subjective Impression—not the object itself, but the impression it makes. 'Rainy day' is subjective atmosphere, not weather.
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	May appear passive but processes rich 'mirror world' internally. Artistic or impressionistic relation to reality.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Fear of novelty, exhaustion. Repressed Ne sees chaos and danger in every new possibility; clings to familiar.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Impressionist artists, archivists, keepers of subjective tradition.

Se

The Extraverted Sensation Type

ORIENTATION	Concrete Experience—no other type equals their capacity for perceiving the concrete world. Sensation is 'fullness of life.'
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	The aesthetes, lovers of good food, fashion, physical experiences. Grounded, pragmatic, oriented to strongest stimulus.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Phobias, obsessive jealousy. Repressed Ni projects 'evil' possibilities—superstitious fears about future or others' intentions.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Connoisseurs, athletes, those fully alive in sensory experience.

Ni

The Introverted Intuitive Type

ORIENTATION	Archetypal Vision—perceives the 'slow processes' of collective unconscious. 'Voice crying in the wilderness.'
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	Mystical dreamers, difficulty communicating vision. Artists, prophets, or socially awkward eccentrics.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Reality detachment, sensual compulsion. Inferior Se manifests as impulsive raw sensuality or fetishism; helpless in physical world.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Prophets, visionary artists, those who perceive what others cannot.

Ne

The Extraverted Intuitive Type

ORIENTATION	Possibility/Change—'keen nose' for what is in the making. 'The harvest is nothing'—abandons when potential exhausted.
HOW IT LOOKS IN LIFE	The 'initiators'—entrepreneurs, speculators, inspirers. Seize situations with enthusiasm for the new.
WHERE IT GETS STUCK	Physical neglect, instability. Suppressed Si leads to exhaustion, hypochondria, or compulsive sensory indulgence.
YOU HAVE MET THIS TYPE IN	Entrepreneurs, venture capitalists, those who see potential everywhere.

Part IV — Four positions, four characters.

The stack is a hierarchy of consciousness. Each position carries its own archetypal flavor — and its own way of failing.

01 **Dominant** · *The Hero*

The Superior Function—the most differentiated and most frequently used tool of the conscious personality. This is the primary instrument of adaptation, the function you identify your character with. Development of this function is the 'Faustian bargain' of civilization: proficiency at the cost of wholeness.

DEVELOPMENT

Fully conscious and under direction of the will. Developed in childhood and adolescence through natural aptitude and environmental reinforcement.

SHADOW

One-sidedness. Over-reliance leads to neglect of other functions and eventual enantiodromia (reversal into the opposite).

02 **Auxiliary** · *The Good Parent*

The second differentiated function that assists the Superior. Because absolute sovereignty of a single function would leave one unable to cope with reality, a secondary mode of adaptation is required. This function must be of opposite rationality to the Dominant.

DEVELOPMENT

Develops in young adulthood as a bridge between the superior function and the rest of the psyche. Provides balance and a secondary mode of adaptation.

SHADOW

May be mistaken for the dominant in some individuals. When underdeveloped, the personality remains rigid and one-dimensional.

03 **Tertiary** · *The Eternal Child (Puer/Puella)*

Less differentiated than the auxiliary and lies closer to the unconscious. Possesses 'infantile' or childlike qualities—playful but also defensive. It often serves as a 'trap' or a 'gift,' luring the ego toward the inferior function.

DEVELOPMENT

Emerges in mid-life as part of the individuation process. Carries the attitude opposite to the dominant. The first step into the 'underworld' of the unconscious stack.

SHADOW

Can manifest defensively when the ego is threatened. May become a source of regression rather than growth if not properly integrated.

04 **Inferior** · *The Anima/Animus (Soul Image)*

The doorway to the unconscious. This function remains archaic, undifferentiated, and largely unconscious. It is the carrier of the 'dark side' of personality—slow, heavy, and charged with primitive affect. Where the ego is most vulnerable and where the wounds of personality reside.

DEVELOPMENT

The 'treasure hard to attain' and the catalyst for individuation. Despite its troublesome nature, it is the bridge to the Self. Integration begins in the second half of life through confrontation with the Shadow.

SHADOW

Operates autonomously—it 'happens' to the subject rather than being willed. Under stress, it erupts primitively (The Grip). The function you are 'seized' by, not the one you use.

Part V — What stress does to each pattern.

When the dominant function is exhausted or defeated, the inferior erupts — archaic, moody, and unlike your ordinary self. Jung's followers call this the grip. Find your dominant below.

Ti dominant → inferior Extraverted Feeling (Fe)

Ordinarily: Analytical, precise, internally consistent, seeking theoretical depth.

In the grip: When a Ti-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Fe erupts. They become desperate for social connection but express it clumsily—either overreacting emotionally to perceived slights or becoming obsessed with how others view them. They may make public emotional scenes or become blindly devoted to another person.

COMMON TRIGGERS

Exclusion from groups. Feeling intellectually inadequate.
Overwhelming social demands.

WHAT HELPS

Low-pressure social interaction. Logical analysis of the situation. Time alone to regain perspective.

Te dominant → inferior Introverted Feeling (Fi)

Ordinarily: Efficient, logical, objective, focused on external systems and results.

In the grip: When an Te-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Fi erupts. They become hypersensitive, taking everything personally. They may withdraw into wounded silence, become uncharacteristically emotional, or develop intense but irrational attachments to people. They feel misunderstood and undervalued.

COMMON TRIGGERS

Feeling dismissed, unappreciated, or when their competence is questioned. Lack of control over environment.

WHAT HELPS

Solitude to process emotions. Acknowledgment of personal values. Physical activity or familiar routines.

Fi dominant → inferior Extraverted Thinking (Te)

Ordinarily: Authentic, principled, governed by deep personal values, inner-directed.

In the grip: When an Fi-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Te erupts as tyrannical external action. They become obsessed with organizing, controlling, and 'fixing' the external world. They may make harsh judgments, issue ultimatums, become ruthlessly efficient, or fixate obsessively on objective facts and details.

COMMON TRIGGERS

Violation of core values. Feeling inauthentic. Being pressured to conform.

WHAT HELPS

Creative expression. Time in nature. Reconnection with personal values through meaningful activity.

Fe**dominant → inferior Introverted Thinking (Ti)****Ordinarily:** Harmonious, empathetic, attuned to social dynamics, values-oriented.**In the grip:** When an Fe-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Ti emerges as cold, obsessive logic. They become hyper-critical, finding fault with everything and everyone. They may develop paranoid thoughts, cynically reduce relationships to 'nothing but' transactions, and obsess over 'the truth' that others are hiding.**COMMON TRIGGERS**

Betrayal of trust. Conflict that cannot be smoothed over.
 Feeling that others are ungrateful.

WHAT HELPS

Logical problem-solving with trusted friend. Physical exercise.
 Acknowledging own needs vs. others' needs.

Si**dominant → inferior Extraverted Intuition (Ne)****Ordinarily:** Thorough, detail-oriented, grounded in experience, respecting tradition.**In the grip:** When an Si-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Ne erupts as catastrophic possibilities. They see danger everywhere, imagine worst-case scenarios, and become paralyzed by all the things that could go wrong. They may become uncharacteristically impulsive or make wild, unfounded accusations.**COMMON TRIGGERS**

Too much novelty. Disruption of routines. Pressure to adapt
 quickly to change.

WHAT HELPS

Return to familiar routines. Focusing on concrete present
 details. Step-by-step problem solving.

Se**dominant → inferior Introverted Intuition (Ni)****Ordinarily:** Present, realistic, action-oriented, attuned to immediate sensory experience.**In the grip:** When an Se-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Ni erupts as dark inner visions. They become convinced of dire future possibilities, develop paranoid interpretations, see 'signs' everywhere, and may become obsessed with a single negative symbolic meaning. They withdraw from the outer world into gloomy internal prophecies.**COMMON TRIGGERS**

Inability to take action. Being physically confined. Loss of
 stimulation.

WHAT HELPS

Physical activity. Returning to present-moment awareness.
 Talking through fears with a trusted person.

Ni**dominant → inferior Extraverted Sensation (Se)****Ordinarily:** Visionary, synthesizing, focused on inner patterns and singular insights.**In the grip:** When an Ni-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Se erupts as raw sensory indulgence. They may become obsessed with physical details, overeat, over-exercise, or engage in impulsive sensory experiences. They can develop fetishistic attachments to specific objects or become completely overwhelmed by sensory stimuli.**COMMON TRIGGERS**

Vision not being realized. Feeling misunderstood.
 Overwhelming external demands.

WHAT HELPS

Controlled sensory experiences (massage, nature). Returning
 to the vision. Creative expression of inner insights.

Ne

dominant → inferior Introverted Sensation (Si)

Ordinarily: Innovative, possibility-oriented, adaptable, seeking patterns and potential.

In the grip: When an Ne-dominant is in The Grip, the repressed Si erupts as obsessive focus on the body and past. They become hypochondriacal, fixating on physical symptoms. They may become depressed about the past, obsessively recall negative experiences, or compulsively overindulge in sensory pleasures (food, drink, etc.).

COMMON TRIGGERS

Too many possibilities with no closure. Feeling scattered.
Physical exhaustion ignored too long.

WHAT HELPS

Rest and physical self-care. Completing one concrete task.
Returning to trusted routines.

Part VI — How the pattern matures.

Individuation is the process of differentiating the individual personality from the collective psychology, integrating conscious and unconscious aspects into a new center: The Self. It is not about becoming 'balanced' in all functions, but about acknowledging and integrating the neglected aspects of the psyche.

1. Differentiation of the Ego

The first half of life establishes the Superior Function and Persona (social mask) for worldly adaptation.

The task: Develop competence with your dominant function. Build a functional ego capable of meeting life's demands.

2. The Midlife Transition

The one-sidedness of the superior function becomes a liability. The unconscious (Shadow/Inferior) presses for recognition.

The task: Recognize the limitations of your dominant approach. Notice recurring failures and frustrations as signals from the unconscious.

3. Confrontation with the Shadow

The ego must acknowledge the dark, inferior parts of personality—the 'Other' within.

The task: Engage with your inferior function, not to master it, but to honor it. Allow yourself to be clumsy, slow, and primitive in this realm.

4. The Transcendent Function

When tension between opposites is held (not repressed), the psyche produces a living symbol that transcends both.

The task: Practice active imagination. Dialogue with unconscious figures. Allow symbols to emerge that unite conscious and unconscious.

5. Realization of the Self

The center of identity shifts from the Ego to the Self—the archetype of wholeness, the 'God-image' within.

The task: This is not an achievement but an ongoing process. The Self is approached asymptotically, never fully attained.

ON THE INFERIOR FUNCTION

The inferior function is not meant to become a second superior function. It remains the doorway to the unconscious—archaic, slow, and charged with numinous energy. The goal is relationship, not mastery. Through the inferior, we touch the collective unconscious and the possibility of transformation.

Part VII — Working with your own map.

Theory becomes useful the week you test it. Pick one prompt, hold it for seven days, and watch your own stack respond.

1. **Meeting Your Shadow.** Find a quiet space and close your eyes. Imagine yourself walking down a path that leads into a dark forest. At a clearing, you encounter a figure—someone who embodies everything you reject about yourself. Don't flee. Ask them: 'What do you want from me?' 'What gift do you carry that I have refused?' Listen without judgment. Write what emerges.
2. **Dialogue with Your Inferior Function.** Visualize your inferior function as a person or creature. What does it look like? Is it young, old, wounded, wild? Approach it with curiosity. Ask: 'Why do you frighten me?' 'What would you teach me if I let you?' Remember—this function holds the treasure hard to attain. Its clumsiness contains your wholeness.
3. **The Inner Guide.** Imagine descending stairs into the depths of your psyche. At the bottom, you find a wise figure waiting—perhaps an old person, an animal, or something unexpected. This is a manifestation of the Self. Ask for guidance on your current life situation. Don't force an answer; let images and words arise naturally. Record everything.
4. **The Unlived Life.** Picture a door marked 'The Life Not Lived.' Open it and step through. What version of yourself exists here—the one who made different choices, developed different aspects? Meet this alternate self. Ask: 'What did you gain that I lost?' 'What did you lose that I gained?' This figure carries your unrealized potential.
5. **The Ancestral Voice.** Allow an ancestor—known or unknown—to appear in your imagination. This may be someone from your family or a symbolic ancestor. Ask: 'What patterns have you passed to me?' 'What wisdom did you fail to pass on?' 'How can I heal what remained unhealed in you?' The personal unconscious connects to the collective.

Your map is the starting point.

This guide describes the general pattern. Your Insight report applies it to your actual scores: your developmental edge, your stress signals, and the one practice worth testing first. Retake the assessment after a season of practice and compare the maps.

typejung.com/results

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